

ACTION PLAN

PesaGuard — What Next

A detailed plan for moving from a complete spec to a validated pilot

Status	6 build prompts and a phased roadmap complete; zero real customer conversations held yet
This document covers	Candidate selection, outreach templates, interview script, evaluation rubric, decision framework, 4-week timeline
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The technical and business planning for PesaGuard is complete. This document is deliberately different in kind - it is not another spec, it is the concrete, detailed plan for validating that spec against real people before building further.

CONTEXT

Where Things Stand

Six build prompts and a phased roadmap now specify PesaGuard end-to-end: core reconciliation pipeline, real matching logic, alerting, monitoring, dashboards, security, backup/DR, incident response, data retention, API docs, testing, deployment, OAuth token handling, staging, dependency scanning, RBAC, data export, API versioning, secrets rotation, tenant provisioning, threat modeling, feature flags, billing, help docs, data residency, localization, and payment-method scope - plus the business/legal checklist (ToS, DPA, ODPC registration, pricing, insurance).

"That is not a gap in planning. That's a complete spec for a genuinely serious fintech product. The actual risk right now isn't 'missing a requirement,' it's spending more time spec'ing instead of validating."

- from this conversation, on why planning should stop here

This document does not add technical scope. It is the operating plan for the one thing that hasn't happened yet: talking to real candidate customers.

01 Selecting Candidates

Not all 5-10 candidates are equally useful to talk to first. Prioritize using these criteria:

Criterion	Why It Matters
Already uses M-Pesa Daraja/Till/Paybill at real volume	No volume, no reconciliation pain to solve
Reconciles manually today (spreadsheet, memory, informal process)	Confirms the actual gap PesaGuard closes
Has some existing internal record system (even informal)	Needed for the matching logic to have anything to match against
Warm connection (Chama/SACCO network, personal referral)	Warm candidates give more honest, detailed answers than cold outreach
Willing to grant read access to internal data eventually	A candidate who can't grant this can't become a real pilot regardless of interest

Suggested Mix

- 2-3 SACCOs (member contributions, loan repayments via M-Pesa)
- 2-3 e-commerce or retail operators (Till/Paybill at volume)
- 1-2 stretch candidates (a small fintech building on Daraja without in-house reconciliation tooling)

Talking to a mix rather than one segment surfaces whether the pain and the language differs meaningfully between SACCOs and e-commerce operators - useful for the localization and scope decisions from Addendum III.

02 Outreach Message

Keep it short, specific, and low-commitment. The goal is a 15-minute conversation, not a sales pitch.

Variant A - Warm Contact (Chama/SACCO network)

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Hi [Name],

I'm building something in the M-Pesa reconciliation space and would
really value 15 minutes of your time -- specifically how [SACCO/business]
currently catches mismatches between M-Pesa payments and your internal
records. Not a sales call, genuinely just trying to understand the real
problem before I build anything further.

Would you have time this week or next for a quick call, or even a few
messages back and forth if that's easier?

Thanks,
Victor
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Variant B - Cold or Semi-Cold Outreach

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Hi [Name],

I'm Victor, a data engineer based in Nairobi. I'm looking into a common
problem for businesses taking M-Pesa payments -- catching mismatches
between what M-Pesa confirms and what your internal records show, often
found days later in a spreadsheet.

Before building anything further, I'm speaking with a handful of
[SACCOs / e-commerce operators] to understand how real this problem is
day-to-day. Would you be open to a brief 15-minute call?

No pitch, just trying to learn from your experience.

Best,
Victor
```

Channel: WhatsApp or SMS for warm contacts; email or LinkedIn for cold outreach. Keep the ask to one specific, small thing (15 minutes).

03 Interview Script

Organize the 15-minute conversation into four short blocks. Let them talk more than you do.

Block 1 - Current State (5 min)

- Walk me through how you currently confirm an M-Pesa payment matches what you expected to receive.
- How do you currently catch M-Pesa payment mismatches or missing callbacks?
- How often does something go wrong - a missing payment, a duplicate, a mismatch?
- How long does it typically take to notice when something's wrong?

Block 2 - Impact (4 min)

- What happens when a mismatch goes unnoticed for a while?
- Who on your team handles this today, and how much time does it take them?
- What would it take for you to trust an automated system over your current process?

Block 3 - Scope & Fit (4 min)

- Besides M-Pesa, do you take payments through Airtel Money, bank transfer, or anything else that would need reconciling too?
- Would you be comfortable granting read-only access to your order/ledger records for a pilot?
- Would you prefer to use a dashboard in Kiswahili, English, or both?
- Is it important that your data is stored in Kenya specifically, or does that not matter to your business?

Block 4 - Close (2 min)

- If something like this existed today, free during a pilot period, would you be interested in trying it?
- Who else do you know who deals with the same problem?

04 Evaluating What You Hear

After each conversation, score it against these signals rather than relying on gut feel alone.

Signal	Strong Positive	Weak / Concerning
Pain description	Specific story with a shilling amount or real incident	Vague, "it's fine, we manage"
Current process	Manual, spreadsheet-based, clearly time-consuming	Already has a solid tool or process in place
Data access willingness	Open to it, or already grants similar access elsewhere	Hesitant or a firm no
Engagement	Asks questions back, wants to know when it's ready	Polite but disengaged
Referral behavior	Volunteers other contacts unprompted	No one comes to mind

Decision rule: if 3 or more of 5-10 conversations show strong positives across most rows, the problem is validated enough to proceed to Path A. If most conversations are weak/concerning, that's real information - see Path B.

05 After the Conversations: Two Paths

Path A - Pain Is Real and Validated

- Pick the single strongest candidate (highest scores across the rubric) as the pilot
- Hand Phases 1-2 of the Master Build Prompt to a coding agent
- Get a shadow-mode pilot running against their real (or closely simulated) data
- Revisit the phased roadmap with them specifically in mind: which of the 15 phases actually matter to this one customer in month one, and which can wait
- Start the localization/residency/scope questions concretely rather than hypothetically

Path B - Weak Signal or Something Unexpected

- Don't force it - a weak signal after real conversations is a cheap, valuable outcome
- Look for a pattern instead: is the pain real but not urgent, is trust the actual blocker, or does a different angle keep coming up
- Revisit the original problem statement with what was actually learned
- Consider whether a narrower wedge is a better starting point than the general PesaGuard framing

06 Four-Week Timeline

Week	Focus
1	Finalize candidate list; send outreach messages; schedule calls
2	Run 5-10 conversations using the interview script; score each against the rubric
3	Synthesize findings; make the Path A / Path B decision; if Path A, select the pilot candidate
4	If Path A: begin Phase 0 sign-off and start Phase 1 of the Master Build Prompt. If Path B: revisit problem framing before any further build work

The one rule that matters most: do not let this timeline slip into more planning. Every tool in this document exists to make the conversations easier to start and easier to learn from - not to be perfected before the first message is sent.